

Tool Survey Proposal: T6 API Testing

1. Candidate Tools Classification

- Traditional Tool:** Postman (Industry-standard suite for functional and integration API testing)
- AI-Augmented Tool:** Postbot (Postman's native AI assistant for automated test generation)
- Backup Tool:** Pact (Consumer-driven contract testing framework)

2. Comparison Matrix

Axis	Postman	Pact	Postbot (Postman AI)
License Cost	Free tier (1 user). Paid: \$12-\$59 per user/month for enterprise features.	Free/Open Source (Framework). Hosted Pactflow scales from \$42+ per user/month.	Included in Postman via tokens. Free: 50 credits/mo. Paid: Higher quotas/add-ons.
Learning Curve	Low. Intuitive GUI; industry standard for API testing.	High. Requires explicit coding (Java/JS/.NET) for consumer-driven contracts.	Very Low. Uses natural language prompts; bypasses deep JavaScript/Chai.js knowledge.
Fit with eshop-sut	Excellent. Ideal for E2E/Integration testing of E-commerce data flows (catalogs/orders).	Poor fit. eshop-sut is a monolith. Pact is for decoupled microservices; using it here is over-engineering.	Excellent. Rapidly generates validation suites for complex JSON payloads (e.g., cart checkouts).
AI Capability	Minimal. Relies entirely on the Postbot add-on.	None. Deterministic, explicit code assertions only.	High. Contextual test generation, JSON parsing, and auto-assertion drafting.
Community	Massive (35M+ users). Vast ecosystem of workspaces and templates.	Medium. Niche, but the definitive standard for Contract Testing.	Growing. Directly leverages Postman's massive user base.

3. Recommended Pick: Postman + Postbot

- 1. Zero Learning Curve:** Eliminates complex framework syntax. The team leverages existing Postman familiarity combined with intuitive AI prompting.
- 2. Rapid Test Coverage:** Auto-generates assertions for deeply nested E-commerce JSON structures (carts/orders) in seconds, eliminating tedious manual validation.
- 3. No Tooling Fatigue:** Avoids the operational overhead of adopting new tools (e.g., Pact Broker setup). Keeps all testing within a single, unified ecosystem.